

| Feature                             | Hardware Firewall                                              | Software Firewall                                                           |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Location</b>                     | A physical device placed between the internet and the network. | Software installed on an individual computer or server.                     |
| <b>Protection</b>                   | Protects all devices connected to the network.                 | Protects only the device on which it is installed.                          |
| <b>Performance &amp; Management</b> | Better suited for large networks and can be managed centrally. | Easier to install and manage but each device must be configured separately. |

## Use Cases

### Hardware Firewall

- **Use Case:** A large office or company uses a hardware firewall to protect hundreds of computers, printers, and servers from external cyber threats through a single security device.

### Software Firewall (e.g., Windows Defender Firewall)

- **Use Case:** A home user or student uses Windows Defender Firewall on a laptop to control which applications can access the internet and to block unauthorized incoming connections.